

Password Reset & Credential Recovery Guide

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SECTION 1: SELF-SERVICE PASSWORD RESET

The fastest way to regain access to your account is through the self-service password reset flow. This process takes under 2 minutes and does not require contacting support.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. Navigate to <https://platform.com/login> in your web browser.
2. Click the 'Forgot Password?' link located below the password input field.
3. Enter the email address associated with your account and click 'Send Reset Link'.
4. Check your inbox for an email from noreply@platform.com with subject line 'Reset Your Password'.
5. The reset link is valid for exactly 15 minutes. If it expires, repeat from Step 2.
6. Click the link and enter your new password. It must meet the security requirements below.
7. Confirm your new password by entering it a second time, then click 'Reset Password'.
8. You will be automatically logged in upon successful reset.

SECTION 2: PASSWORD SECURITY REQUIREMENTS

All passwords must satisfy the following requirements to be accepted by the system:

- Minimum length: 12 characters
- At least one uppercase letter (A–Z)
- At least one lowercase letter (a–z)

- At least one digit (0–9)
- At least one special character from the set: ! @ # \$ % ^ & * () _ + - = [] { }
- Cannot match any of your last 5 previously used passwords
- Cannot contain your email address or username

SECTION 3: NOT RECEIVING THE RESET EMAIL

If the password reset email has not arrived within 5 minutes, follow these steps:

1. Check your spam or junk mail folder. Email clients sometimes misclassify automated emails.
2. Ensure you are checking the correct email account. You may have registered with a different email address.
3. Add noreply@platform.com to your safe senders list or contacts.
4. If your organization uses email filtering software, ask your IT team to whitelist the platform.com domain.
5. Try the reset flow again. Generating a new link invalidates the previous one.
6. If you still cannot receive the email after 30 minutes, contact support@platform.com.

SECTION 4: ACCOUNT LOCKOUT

Accounts are automatically locked after 10 consecutive failed login attempts within a 1-hour window. This is a security measure to prevent brute force attacks.

Automatic Unlock: Locked accounts automatically unlock after 30 minutes of no login attempts.

Immediate Unlock Options:

Option A: Use the 'Forgot Password?' flow, which also unlocks the account.

Option B: Contact support@platform.com with your account email. Our team can unlock immediately after verifying your identity.

SECTION 5: TWO-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (2FA) RECOVERY

If you have 2FA enabled and have lost access to your authenticator device, use one of your backup recovery codes.

How to Use a Backup Code:

1. On the 2FA prompt screen, click 'Use a backup code instead'
2. Enter one of your 8 one-time backup codes
3. Each backup code can only be used once
4. After logging in, immediately generate new backup codes in Account Settings → Security

If All Backup Codes Are Lost:

Contact security@platform.com with a government-issued photo ID for identity verification. Our security team will disable 2FA on your account after verification. This process takes 1–2 business days for security reasons.

SECTION 6: SSO (SINGLE SIGN-ON) USERS

If your organization uses Single Sign-On (SSO) via SAML 2.0 or OAuth, your password is managed by your identity provider (e.g., Okta, Azure AD, Google Workspace), not by our platform.

To reset an SSO-linked password:

- Contact your internal IT department or Help Desk
- Use your organization's self-service password reset tool
- Our platform cannot reset passwords for SSO-linked accounts

SECTION 7: CONTACTING SUPPORT FOR CREDENTIAL ISSUES

If self-service options have failed, contact our support team:

- Email: support@platform.com
- Subject line: 'Credential Recovery — [Your Email Address]'
- Include: Account email, approximate account creation date, and company name
- Response time: Within 24 hours (Pro plan), Within 4 hours (Enterprise plan)

For security purposes, our support team will never ask for your password. If anyone claiming to be platform support requests your password, do not provide it and report the incident to security@platform.com.